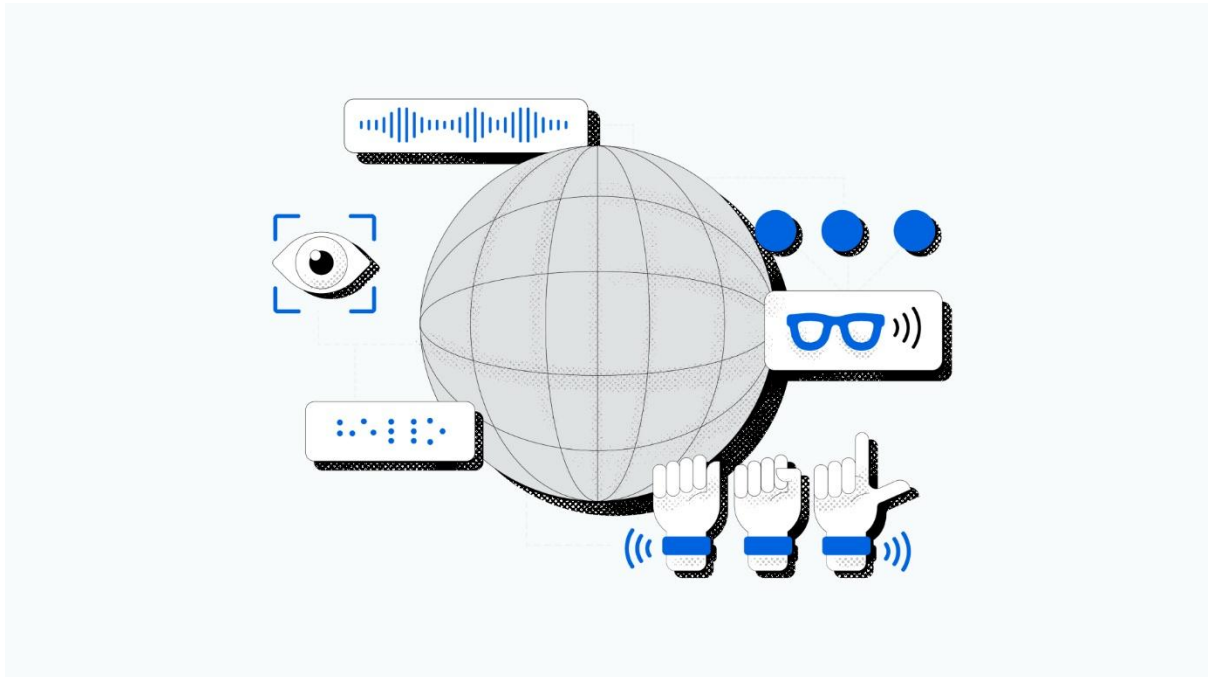


[Meta](#)

Our AI Wearables Are “Changing the Game” for Disabled People

May 18, 2026

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Takeaways

- We’re rolling out new features on our AI glasses designed to be more intuitive and hands-free — updates that make the technology more accessible to people across diverse communities, including those who are blind or low vision, or those with mobility disabilities.
- Our Meta Wearables Device Access Toolkit provides resources for developers to build third-party apps for our AI glasses that help people with disabilities navigate daily life with greater independence.
- We’re also hosting a bike club event at our Meta Lab Store in New York City, bringing together athletes with disabilities who will be biking while wearing their Oakley Meta Performance Glasses.

More than one billion people around the world live with some form of disability, and we’ve seen how our wearable AI is making a real difference for many of them — from enabling people who are blind to describe their surroundings to giving veterans with memory loss more co

confidence in daily routines. Today, ahead of Global Accessibility Awareness Day, we're sharing how we're building on that impact.

Donald Overton, a US Army veteran who lost his sight from a blast in Iraq while serving with the 82nd Airborne Division, uses his Meta AI glasses, developed in partnership with EssilorLuxottica, to navigate airports, read menus, and move through his day without the backpack full of assistive devices he used to carry.

"I can now go out to dinner with my wife and have a normal date night. I'm able to use the technology to read the menu to me," he said.

Video Player

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[Noah Currier, a Marine Corps veteran](#) with quadriplegia and founder of the Oscar Mike Foundation, uses Ray-

Ban Meta glasses to capture photos and videos entirely by voice — something he says is "changing the game" for physically disabled people.

"I'm a quadriplegic, so my hands don't work. I probably have fewer photos and videos in my phone than anybody else in the world," he said. "Being able to take them hands-free was incredible. The very first thing I did was take a picture of my baby when I got home."

Stories like these are what drive us to keep expanding what our AI glasses can do, including our latest features.

More Ways to Stay Connected

We're rolling out new features on our AI glasses that give people more ways to navigate their day without needing to reach for their phone or tap on their frames.

Group calling and Service Directory with Be My Eyes: Building on our partnership with [Be My Eyes](#), people who are blind or have low vision can now say "Hey Meta, Be My Eyes with [name]" to start a hands-

free video call with a trusted friend or family member — rather than connecting with a sighted volunteer. You can also connect with specially trained support representatives from global brands like Tesco, Sony, Amtrak, and Hilton, who are equipped to provide visual descriptions and hands-on assistance with tasks.

Voice controls during calls: Soon you'll be able to manage calls on WhatsApp, Messenger, Instagram, and Be My Eyes entirely by voice — muting, unmuting, turning your video on or off, or hanging up — all without touching your glasses or phone. For people with limited hand mobility, it means fewer barriers to staying connected.

One-touch shortcuts: You can now customize the action button on [Ray-Ban Meta Optics styles](#) or Oakley Meta Vanguard glasses for instant access to the features you use most — whether that’s connecting to a Be My Eyes volunteer or asking a Meta AI prompt like “describe what’s around me.” A single press replaces multi-step voice commands, putting AI a fingertip away.

Captioned calls: We recently introduced real-time captions during phone, WhatsApp, Facebook Messenger, and Instagram Direct voice calls on Meta Ray-Ban Display glasses that show what the other person is saying right on your in-lens display. Don’t miss a word and stay hands-free, even on a busy street or in a loud café — making calls more accessible wherever you are.

Third-Party Apps Built for Our AI Glasses

We’re already seeing incredible creativity from developers using the [Meta Wearables Device Access Toolkit](#) (DAT), and we can’t wait to see what they build next to make our AI glasses even more useful for everyone.

Our DAT gives developers a way to extend their mobile apps onto our AI glasses — and some of the first experiences are designed to help people with disabilities navigate daily life with more independence.

- [OO Orion](#) helps blind and low-vision people locate objects, read text, detect obstacles, and understand their surroundings through real-time, hands-free AI assistance. Simply tell OO Orion what you’re looking for, and it actively guides you toward it with live audio feedback as you move. Users can also scan and save personal items — such as keys, wallets, or phones — so they can easily find them later. Whether at home, at work, or on the go in partner locations such as hotels, museums, or stores, OO Orion helps users navigate their environment independently and with confidence.
- [Aira](#) connects blind and low vision individuals with professionally trained Visual Interpreters, providing secure, on-demand support. By integrating with our AI glasses, Aira users receive real-time visual information based on their field of view while keeping both hands free for canes, guide dogs, and everyday tasks. Backed by enterprise-grade privacy and training standards, Aira enhances independence and empowers access on your terms.

Turning Muscle Signals Into Independent Control

Through a three-year partnership with Carnegie Mellon University, we're exploring how electromyography (EMG) — the technology behind Meta Ray-Ban Display's accompanying Meta Neural Band — can give people with spinal cord injuries new ways to interact with digital devices. The neural band detects subtle muscle signals in the forearm, even in people who have been paralyzed for many years, and translates them into actions like clicking, scrolling, or even steering in a video game.

In the video below, a participant named Cass with a spinal cord injury competes in a multiplayer racing game against a player using a standard controller — steering and boosting entirely through hand gestures captured by two Meta Neural Bands.

Video Player

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01:44

Accessibility in Action

We're looking forward to hosting an event on Global Accessibility Awareness Day — May 21, 2026 — at Meta Lab NYC in partnership with [Lighthouse Guild](#), a blind-led nonprofit with more than 120 years of service to the blind and low vision community, and [Achilles International](#), the leading nonprofit that empowers athletes with disabilities through inclusive athletic experiences. People in the blind and low-vision community can experience our Oakley Meta Vanguard glasses firsthand through a Bike Club, showing how our wearable technology can unlock new possibilities in everyday athletic experiences. [In March](#), Lighthouse Guild CEO Thomas Panek, who is blind, completed the New York City Half Marathon with the help of Oakley Meta Vanguard glasses.

We're committed to building technology that's accessible to everyone from the start. These updates are one step in that work, and we're excited to share more as we continue to expand what's possible for people with disabilities.

Categories

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[Meta Technology and Innovation](#)

Tags:

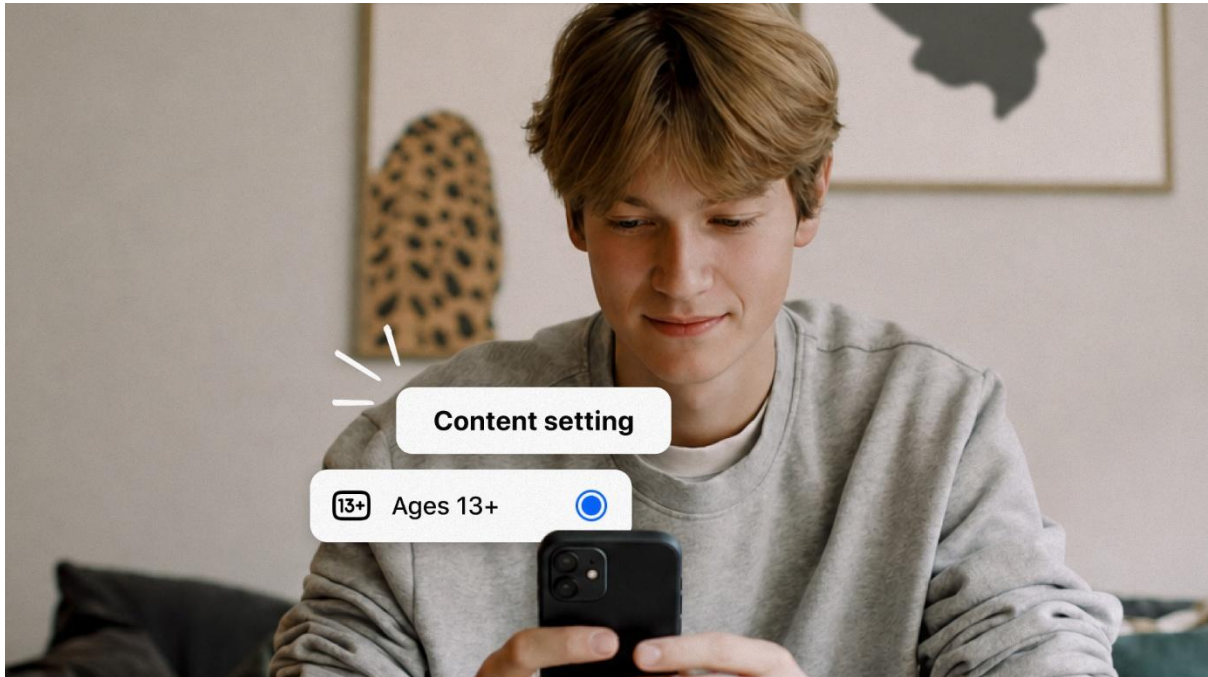
[Accessibility](#) [AI](#) [AI Glasses](#)

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New 13+ Content Settings for Teen Accounts Expanding Globally on Instagram, Facebook, and Messenger

June 2, 2026

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Takeaways

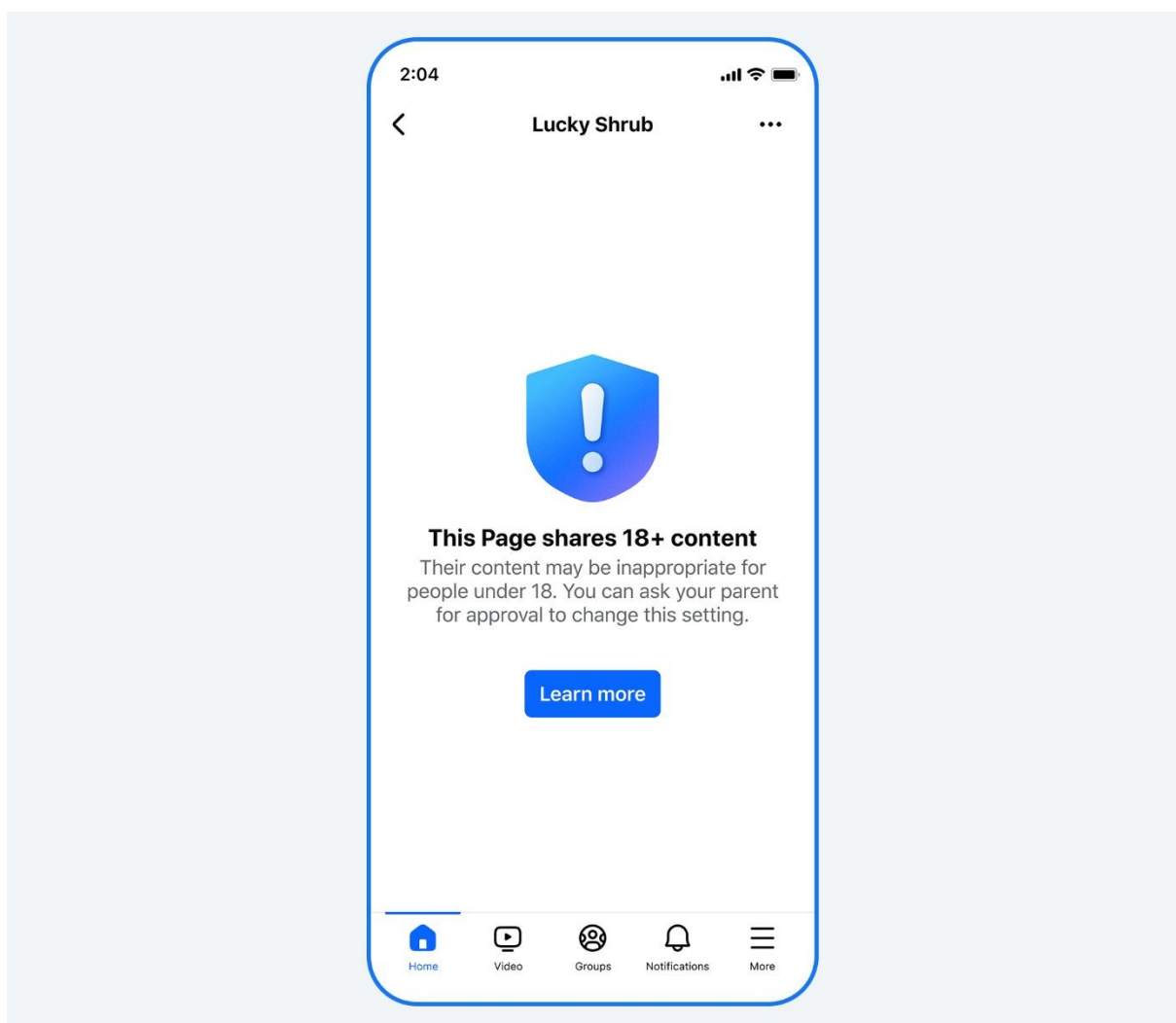
- Teen Accounts' new 13+ content settings are now expanding globally on Instagram, Facebook and Messenger.
- We're testing a new feature on Instagram that helps teens get more variety in what they see and helps prevent them from seeing certain types of content repeatedly.
- An external assessment showed that Instagram Teen Accounts' new content settings are working as promised.

Last October, we updated Instagram Teen Accounts in the US, UK, Australia, and Canada, defaulting teens into a new 13+ content setting. Inspired by movie ratings criteria and parent feedback, this setting is designed to help teens see age-appropriate content by default, and 9 out of 10 teens have remained in this setting since its launch. We also introduced a stricter setting called Limited Content, for parents who prefer an even more restrictive experience for their teen.

Today, we're sharing an update on this work, including testing a new way to help make sure teens aren't repeatedly seeing certain types of content.

Expanding Our New 13+ Content Settings To Instagram, Facebook and Messenger Teen Accounts Globally

We're expanding our 13+ content settings to Teen Accounts globally across Instagram, Facebook, and Messenger. Facebook's new 13+ default setting is designed to hide content that's inappropriate for teens in places like Feed and Reels, and to limit teens' ability to interact with Profiles, Pages, Groups and Events that primarily post inappropriate content. On Messenger, the 13+ default setting limits teens' ability to view links to inappropriate Facebook content, or to chat with accounts that primarily share inappropriate content on Facebook. The Limited Content setting will also become available on Facebook and Messenger later this year.



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As we've expanded the new content settings to more countries and apps, we've also continued to invite parents around the world to rate Facebook and Instagram content and tell us if t

hey think it's appropriate for teens. We've heard from hundreds of thousands of parents who have rated more than 15 million pieces of content. In our most recent survey at the end of April, where parents in the US, UK, Australia, and Canada reviewed Facebook content that had been recommended to teens in their respective countries, fewer than 2% of posts were considered inappropriate for teens by most parents.

A New Way to Help Prevent Teens From Repeatedly Seeing Certain Types of Content on Instagram

We're also continuing to explore other ways to help make sure teens are having positive, age-

appropriate experiences on our apps. We recognize that some content — like posts about nutrition, weightlifting, or how to cope with anxiety — can be helpful, but it should be balanced with other types of content rather than shown repeatedly. That's why we're testing ways to limit teens from seeing too many posts of this kind in one go, including in Explore, Feed, and Reels.

An External Assessment To Stress-Test Our Teen Account Content Settings

To help make sure our new content settings are working to deliver the positive, age-appropriate experience we want for Teen Accounts, we asked [Alice](#) (formerly ActiveFence) to evaluate our Teen Account settings and perform sophisticated, adversarial stress-testing. Alice is made up of online safety experts with extensive experience in stress-testing systems designed to keep people safe.

Alice compared mature themes, based on Meta's [age-appropriate guidelines](#), found on Instagram, a leading competitor, and in movies rated 13+. This provided a helpful benchmark to understand what teens could see on Instagram Teen Accounts compared to elsewhere. Alice's assessment found that:

- Instagram Teen Accounts in the default 13+ setting saw 68% less mature content than on the competitor's teen experience;
- Instagram Teen Accounts in the stricter Limited Content setting experienced an additional layer of protection, seeing 96% less mature content than on the competitor's teen experience;
- Where Instagram Teen Accounts did see mature content, it was less intense than the mature content seen on the competitor and in movies rated 13+;
- Instagram blocked mature search terms more frequently than its competitor;
- The following functionalities worked as described: Instagram Teen Accounts are defaulted into the 13+ content setting; teens can't select the More Content setting without a parent's permission, and teens in the Limited Content setting can't see or post comments.

Alice's analysis identified two areas for improvement, which we worked quickly to address.

- Instagram Teen Accounts already had safeguards in place to prevent interaction with accounts that regularly share age-inappropriate content. When Alice's assessment identified a few exceptions, we immediately updated our detection signals to better catch them. As the Alice report notes, "these improvement measures were subsequently retested and found to be effective prior to publication."
- In the rare instances where Alice's researchers encountered mature content on Instagram, it mostly involved "risky stunts" or "viral challenges." After review, we found that "car surfing" — a newly popular trend — wasn't yet covered by our policies, unlike "subway surfing," which was already restricted for teens. We moved quickly to update our policies and restrict this content for teens.

We are encouraged by these results, and will continue to rigorously stress test our systems to help us keep improving. More details on Alice's results and the methodology are available [here](#).

Note: There are lots of differences between social media and movies. We didn't work with the MPA when updating our content settings, and they're not rating any content on Instagram, and they're not endorsing or approving our content settings in any way. Rather, we drew inspiration from the MPA's public guidelines, which are already familiar to parents, as well as feedback from parents. Our content moderation systems are not the same as a movie ratings board, so the experience may not be exactly the same.

Categories

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[Facebook](#) [Instagram](#) [Messenger](#) [Product News](#) [Safety and Expression](#)

Tags:

[Youth Well-Being Resources](#)

Protecting Players and Fans during FIFA World Cup 2026™

May 28, 2026

Listen to Article



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Takeaways

- In the lead up to FIFA World Cup 2026™, we're taking comprehensive measures to combat scams, reduce abuse, and protect fans and players throughout the tournament.
- Starting this week, when people search for terms related to FIFA World Cup™ tickets on Facebook or visit related Groups, we'll remind them of what to look out for before buying tickets and link to our reporting tools if they've encountered suspicious content or accounts.
- We're expanding protections for players and taking action on abusive content through continued enforcement of our rules against bullying and harassment and hateful conduct.

In the coming months, soccer fans across the globe will use our apps to connect around the FIFA World Cup 2026™. While most will be rooting for their favorite teams and players, unfortunately there may be bad actors who will try to lure people into scams or harass and abuse others — offline and online.

Before the competition kicks off, we're sharing more details about the steps we're taking to combat scams and keep fans and players safe.

Combating Scams

Scammers are constantly evolving their tactics and so are we. That's why we [recently announced](#) new investments in advanced AI, tools for people to spot and avoid scams, and partner

ships with law enforcement and industry peers to take action and hold scammers accountable.

Global sporting events can lead to an increase in fraud, like ticketing scams, false offers of immigration processing, and misleading accommodations for those looking to travel to matches. We have dedicated teams monitoring and enforcing against accounts that attempt to target people with these scams and violate our policies.

We know scammers rarely target only one platform, so we're working across industry to disrupt scam networks through the Global Signal Exchange (GSE) and Meta's Fraud Intelligence Reciprocal Exchange (FIRE). Meta collaborated with Visa through the GSE, to proactively disrupt cross-

channel fraud. By providing timely and actionable scam intelligence, Visa's Scam Disruption team facilitated Meta's identification and dismantling of a network on Facebook that linked to spoofed websites that mimicked the FIFA World Cup 2026 official branding and promoted fake gambling content. These fraudulent websites advertised too-good-to-be-true win rates and attempted to lure people to provide personal or financial information.

We will continue to take action and work with our partners through our signal sharing programs to get ahead of evolving scam tactics in the lead-up to, during, and after the FIFA World Cup.

Educating Consumers

Starting this week, we're launching a Facebook pop up notification that will remind people throughout the tournament to make sure they get tickets from verifiable sources. When people search for terms related to FIFA World Cup tickets on Facebook or visit related Groups, we'll remind them what to look out for before buying tickets, and also share links to our reporting tool so they can report suspicious content or accounts.

2:04



🔍 Football tickets



Posts

People

Videos

Groups

Pages



Looking for tickets?

Learn how Meta works to keep fans safe online and ways to avoid scams.

[See safety tips](#)



Football Tickets Buy and Sell · [Join](#)

Public · 21.8K members · 40+ posts a day

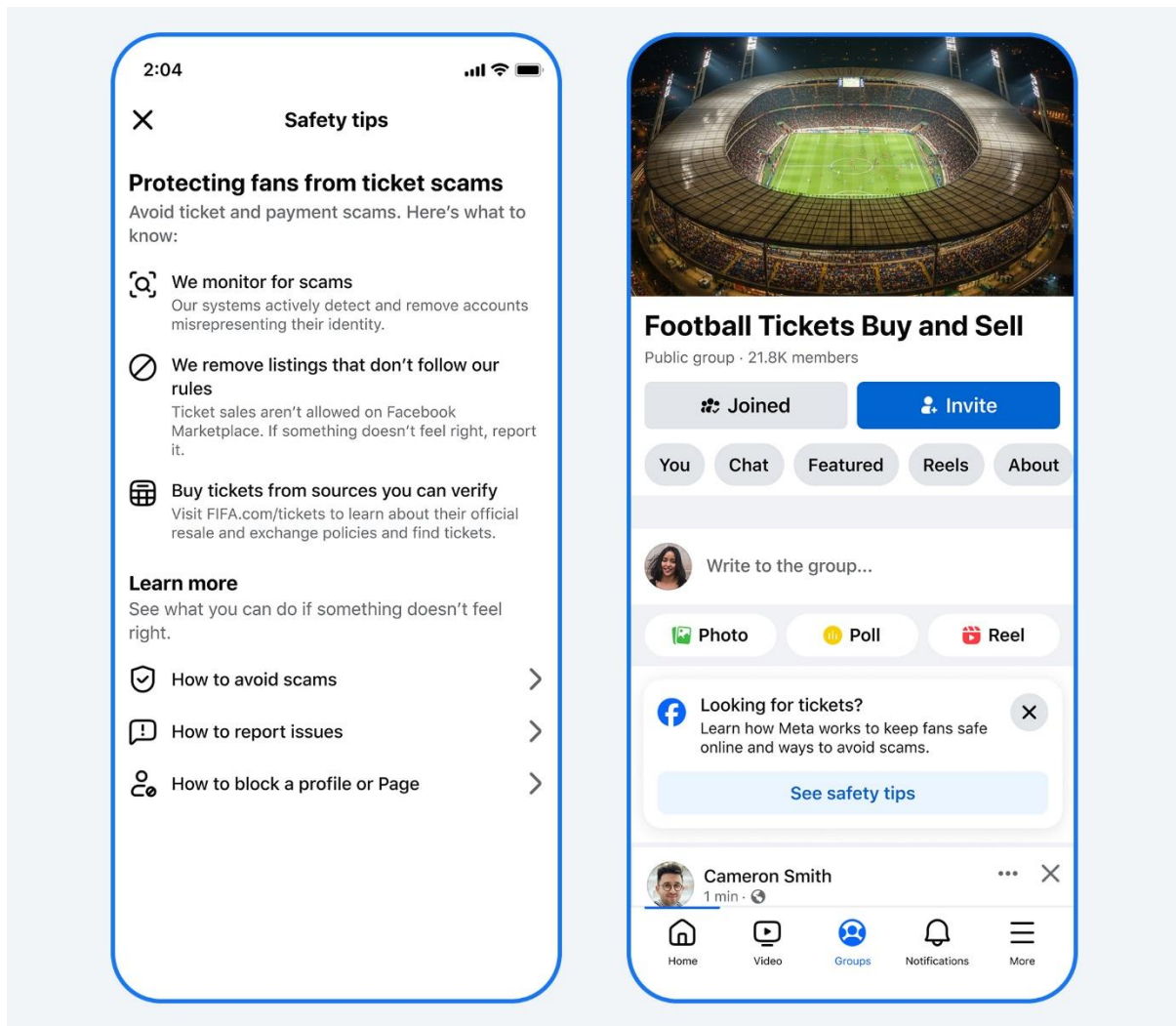


Football Collectors: Football tickets, Buy, Sell or Exchange · [Join](#)

Private · 2.3K members · 10+ posts a day



FOOTBALL SOCCER TICKETS, Buy



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We also continue to invest in consumer education along with our partners to help people learn how they can spot and avoid scams and stay safe online. We're supporting partners like the Canadian Anti-

Fraud Centre (CAFC), Canada's national fraud and cybercrime intake and coordination unit that supports counter fraud efforts across the country, and Stand Against Scams, on a national anti-

scam awareness campaign led by the Canadian Anti-Scam Coalition, to help fans stay informed and protected online.

We're also partnering with Mexico's Consumer Protection Agency ([PROFECO](#)), to launch a creator-

led campaign that raises awareness about common scams expected around the tournament, such as fake ticket sales and impersonation of official FIFA World Cup related websites.

DON'T LET TICKETING SCAMS RUIN YOUR PLANS



STAND
AGAINST SCAMS™

 Meta

This image is part of our collaboration with Stand Against Scams.



ONLY
use verified resellers



DON'T
buy through DMs



DON'T pay with
cash or e-transfer

**STAND
AGAINST SCAMS™**

 **Meta**

This image is part of our collaboration with Stand Against Scams.

Combating Abuse

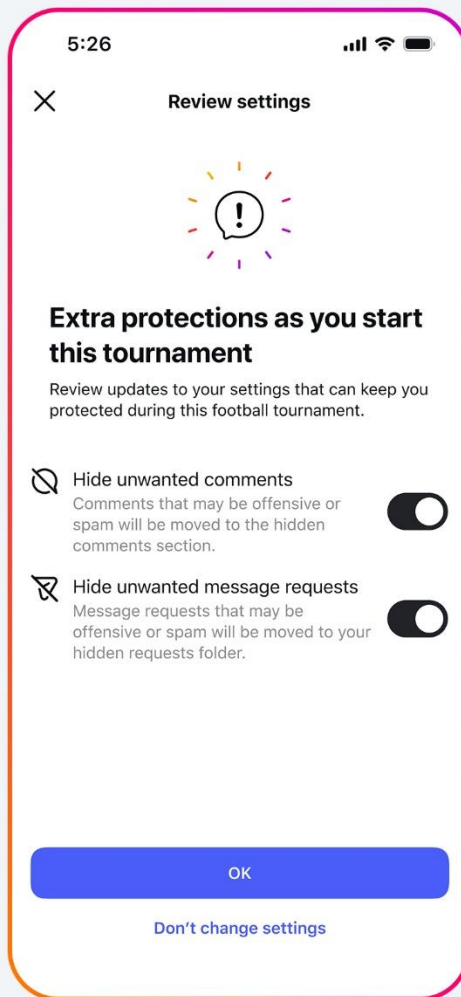
We have clear rules against [bullying and harassment](#), violent threats, and hateful conduct toward both players and fans. No one should be subject to this kind of abuse, and we remove this content when we find it. We use reports from our community and AI technology to proactively detect content that violates our policies. We also [regularly report](#) on our progress to enforce these policies. Between October and December 2025, we removed 2.6 million pieces of hateful content on Facebook and Instagram, and found more than 74% of it before anyone reported it to us.

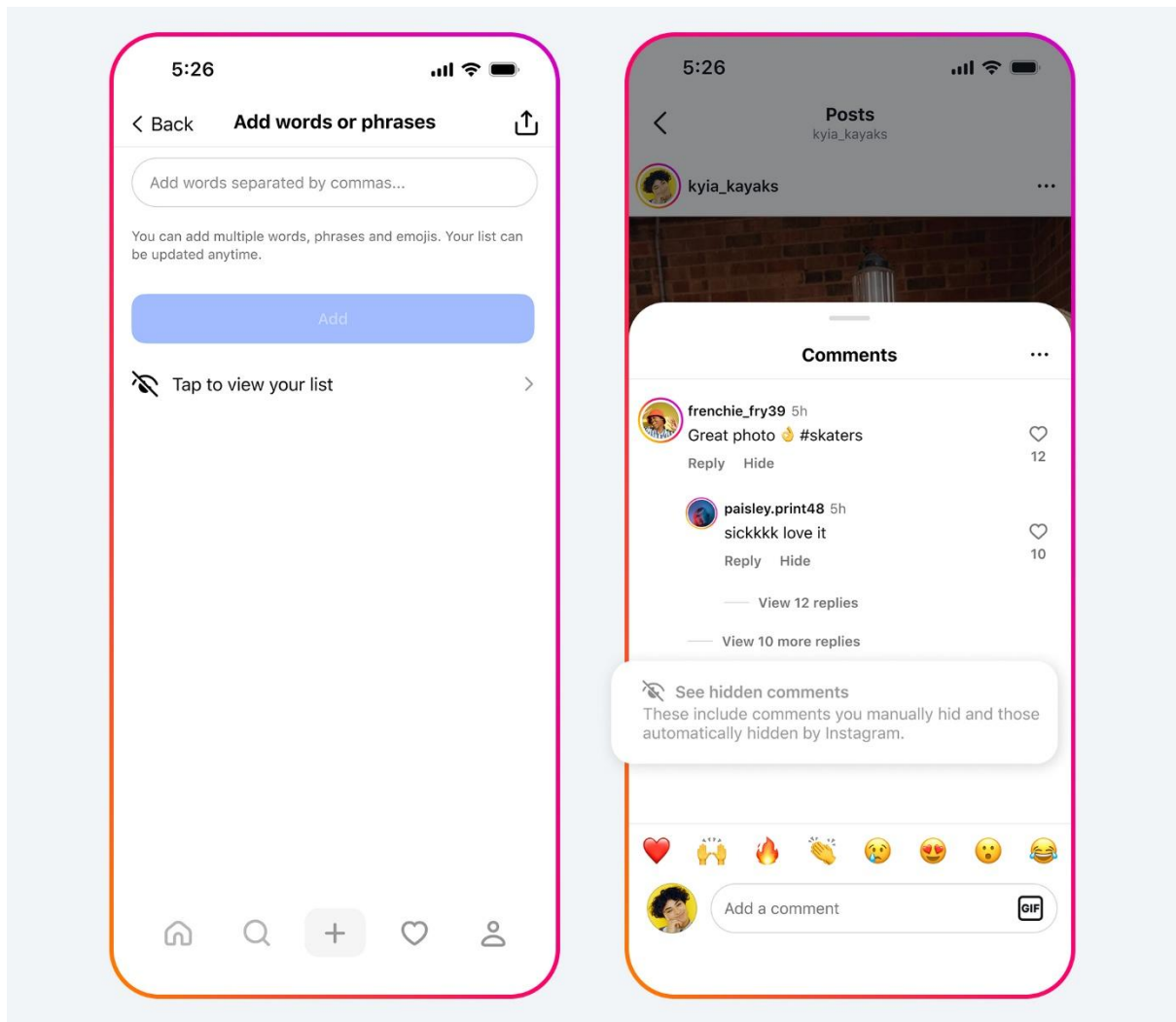
We regularly speak to players, teams, and associations around the world to make sure they know about our latest safety policies and features, and we continue to listen carefully to their feedback.

In addition to detecting and removing violating content, we continue to develop and update features to help people stay safe on our apps. For example, on Facebook and Instagram, we've introduced features like [Restrict](#) and [tag and mention controls](#) to help reduce unwanted contact, comments, and tags. On Facebook, professional accounts can use [Moderation Assist](#), an automation tool for controlling which comments appear on their Page or profile based on certain criteria like new comments with images or links.

People can also turn off DM requests on Instagram — meaning they won't receive messages from anyone they don't follow — and report potentially violating messages to us. However, some public figures have told us they want to leave DM requests on to hear from fans and other members of their community. That's why we've developed additional safety tools.

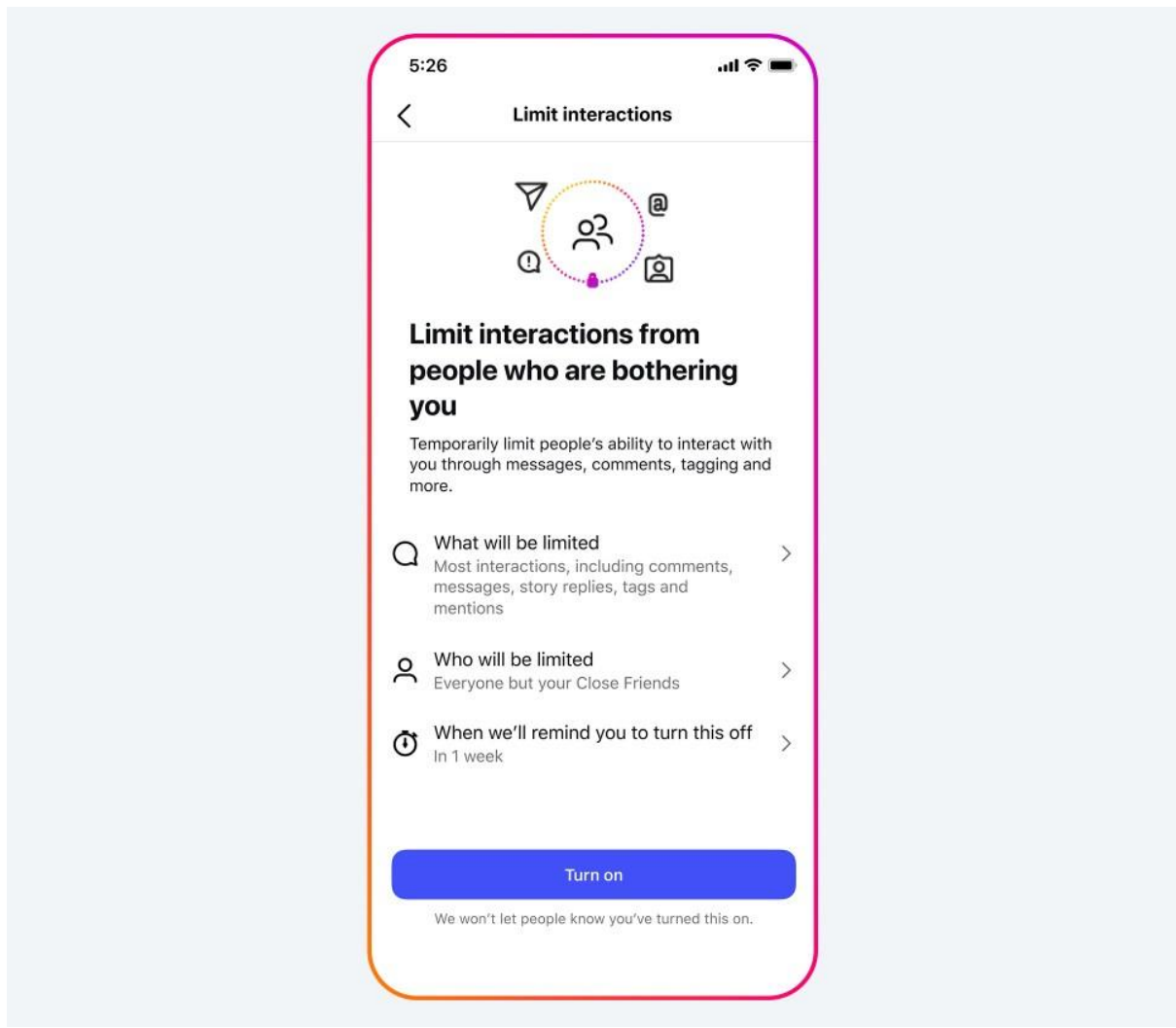
Hidden Words: This Instagram [safety feature](#) automatically filters comments or DM requests containing offensive words, phrases, emojis, and spam content you don't want to see. For comments, you can choose to hide "some" comments on your posts or "more" for even higher levels of protection. You can also customize your own Hidden Words list to filter out DM requests or comments that include those specific words. Facebook will be rolling out a similar setting for FIFA World Cup tournament athletes and teams to hide comments with potentially offensive content.



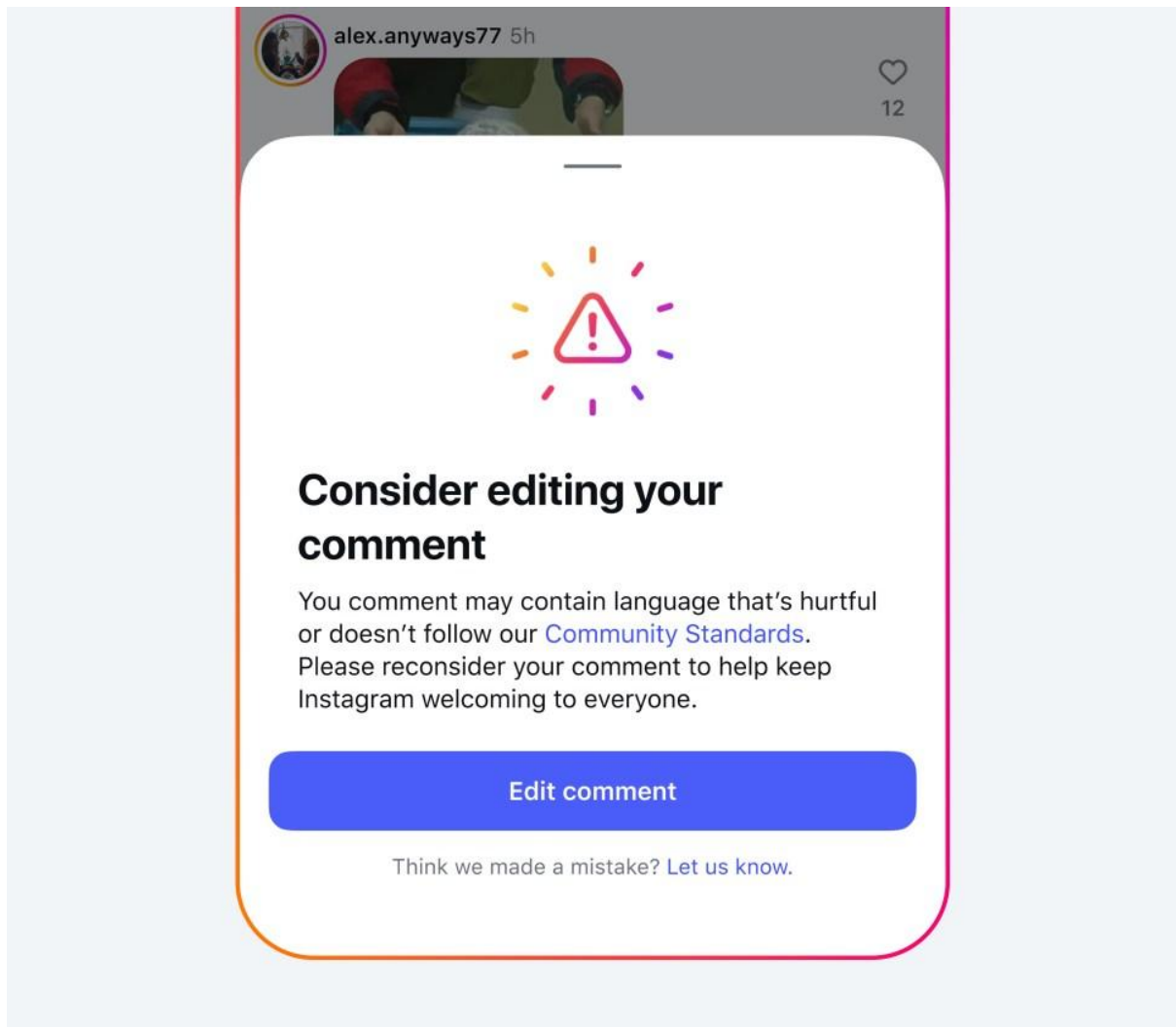


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Limit Interactions: This [feature](#), when turned on, temporarily restricts comments and DMs from specific groups of people, including those who don't follow you or only recently followed you. This is particularly useful for public figures who experience sudden spikes of comments and DMs related to public events, like their performance in a soccer match.



Stronger Blocking and Abuse Prevention: In recent years, we've made it harder for abusers to reach people by simply creating a new profile. We've also rolled out nudges on Instagram that prompt people to reconsider before posting something that may be hurtful.



We'll continue developing tools to protect our community, and work closely with officials to help keep our apps safe for players and fans.

Categories

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